

## PRACTCAL Week\_4

**Task 1:** Write a C program where a parent process creates multiple child processes and synchronizes their completion using `wait()` and `waitpid()`. Compare the behavior of both functions.

```
GNU nano 7.2                                wait_compare.c *
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <unistd.h>
#include <sys/wait.h>

int main() {
    pid_t child1, child2, child3;
    int status;

    printf("Parent Process: PID = %d\n\n", getpid());

    // Create Child 1
    child1 = fork();

    if (child1 == 0) {
        printf("Child 1: PID = %d\n", getpid());
        sleep(3);
        printf("Child 1 completed.\n");
        exit(1);
    }

    // Create Child 2
    child2 = fork();

    if (child2 == 0) {
        printf("Child 2: PID = %d\n", getpid());
        sleep(1);
        printf("Child 2 completed.\n");
        exit(2);
    }

    // Create Child 3
    child3 = fork();

    if (child3 == 0) {
        printf("Child 3: PID = %d\n", getpid());
        sleep(2);
        printf("Child 3 completed.\n");
        exit(3);
    }
}
```

```
// Parent uses wait()
printf("\nParent using wait():\n");

pid_t finished = wait(&status);

printf("wait() collected child PID = %d\n", finished);

if (WIFEXITED(status))
    printf("Exit status = %d\n", WEXITSTATUS(status));

// Parent uses waitpid()
printf("\nParent using waitpid() for Child 1:\n");

waitpid(child1, &status, 0);

printf("waitpid() collected Child 1 PID = %d\n", child1);

if (WIFEXITED(status))
    printf("Exit status = %d\n", WEXITSTATUS(status));

// Collect remaining children
waitpid(child3, &status, 0);
printf("Remaining Child 3 completed.\n");

waitpid(child2, &status, 0);
printf("Remaining Child 2 completed.\n");

printf("\nParent process completed.\n");

return 0;
}
```

```

varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ nano wait_compare.c
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ gcc wait_compare.c -o wait_compare
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ ./wait_compare
Parent Process: PID = 1996

Child 1: PID = 1997

Child 2: PID = 1998
Parent using wait():
Child 3: PID = 1999
Child 2 completed.
wait() collected child PID = 1998
Exit status = 2

Parent using waitpid() for Child 1:
Child 3 completed.
Child 1 completed.
waitpid() collected Child 1 PID = 1997
Exit status = 1
Remaining Child 3 completed.
Remaining Child 2 completed.

Parent process completed.

```

| ALGORITHM: Parent Creates Multiple Children and Synchronizes using waitpid() |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.                                                                           | START                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2.                                                                           | Declare an array child[NUM_CHILDREN] to store child PIDs and an integer status.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 3.                                                                           | Print a message indicating the parent process has started along with its PID.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 4.                                                                           | <div> <b>For</b> <math>i \leftarrow 0</math> to NUM_CHILDREN - 1 <b>do</b> <div> 4.1 Call fork() and store the return value in child[i].<br/> 4.2 <b>If</b> fork() &lt; 0 <b>then</b><br/> 4.3     Print error message and terminate the program.<br/> 4.4 <b>Else if</b> fork() == 0 <b>then</b>     // Child process <div> 4.4.1 Print message: "Child <math>i + 1</math> started" along with child PID.<br/> 4.4.2 Sleep for <math>(i + 1) \times 2</math> seconds (to create different completion times).<br/> 4.4.3 Print message: "Child <math>i + 1</math> completed".<br/> 4.4.4 Exit the child process with exit status <math>(i + 1)</math>. </div> </div> </div> |
| 5.                                                                           | <b>End For</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 6.                                                                           | Print message: Parent waiting for children using waitpid().                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 7.                                                                           | <b>For</b> $i \leftarrow 0$ to NUM_CHILDREN - 1 <b>do</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 8.                                                                           | Call waitpid(child[i], &status, 0) and store the return value in pid.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 9.                                                                           | <b>If</b> waitpid() == -1 <b>then</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 10.                                                                          | Print error message and terminate the program.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 11.                                                                          | <b>Else</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 12.                                                                          | <b>If</b> WIFEXITED(status) is true <b>then</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 13.                                                                          | Print: Child with PID pid terminated with exit status WEXITSTATUS(status).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 14.                                                                          | <b>End If</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 15.                                                                          | <b>End If</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 16.                                                                          | <b>End For</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 17.                                                                          | Print message: All child processes completed. Parent exiting.<br>STOP                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

## Observation

1. The parent successfully creates **multiple child processes** using fork().
2. wait() collects **any child that terminates first**.
3. waitpid() allows the parent to **wait for a specific child using its PID**.
4. Both functions synchronize the parent and prevent child processes from remaining as zombies after they are collected.

**Task 2:** Create a scenario where a child process becomes a zombie process. Investigate the process table and then modify the program to eliminate zombie processes using proper synchronization techniques.

```
GNU nano 7.2 zombie.c *
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <unistd.h>

int main() {
    pid_t pid = fork();

    if (pid < 0) {
        perror("fork failed");
        return 1;
    }

    if (pid == 0) {
        printf("Child Process\n");
        printf("Child PID = %d\n", getpid());
        printf("Child is terminating...\n");
        exit(0);
    }

    else {
        printf("Parent Process\n");
        printf("Parent PID = %d\n", getpid());
        printf("Child PID = %d\n", pid);

        printf("Parent is sleeping...\n");
        sleep(30);

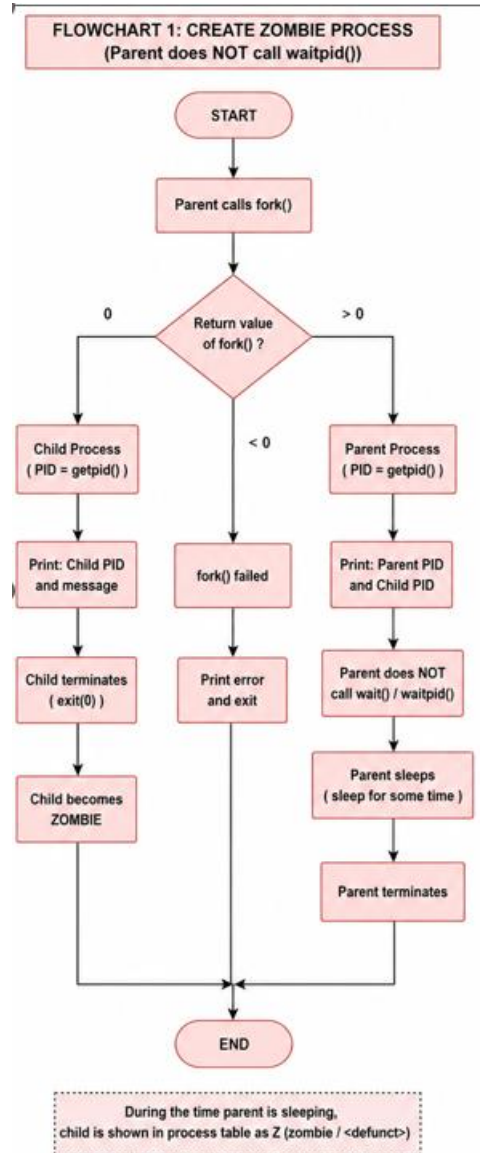
        printf("Parent completed.\n");
    }

    return 0;
}
```

```
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ nano zombie.c
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ gcc zombie.c -o zombie
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ ./zombie
Parent Process
Parent PID = 2029
Child PID = 2030
Parent is sleeping...
Child Process
Child PID = 2030
Child is terminating...
```

```
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ ps -o pid,ppid,state,stat,cmd | grep 2156
2159    2108 S S+  grep --color=auto 2156
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ grep "^State" /proc/2156/status
State:  Z (zombie)
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ |
```

## Flow Chart:



```

GNU nano 7.2                                zombie.c *
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <unistd.h>
#include <sys/wait.h>

int main() {
    pid_t pid;

    pid = fork();

    if (pid < 0) {
        perror("fork failed");
        return 1;
    }

    if (pid == 0) {
        printf("Child Process\n");
        printf("Child PID = %d\n", getpid());
        printf("Child is terminating...\n");
        exit(0);
    }

    else {
        printf("Parent Process\n");
        printf("Parent PID = %d\n", getpid());
        printf("Child PID = %d\n", pid);

        printf("Parent waiting for child...\n");

        wait(NULL);

        printf("Child collected successfully.\n");
        printf("No zombie process remains.\n");
    }

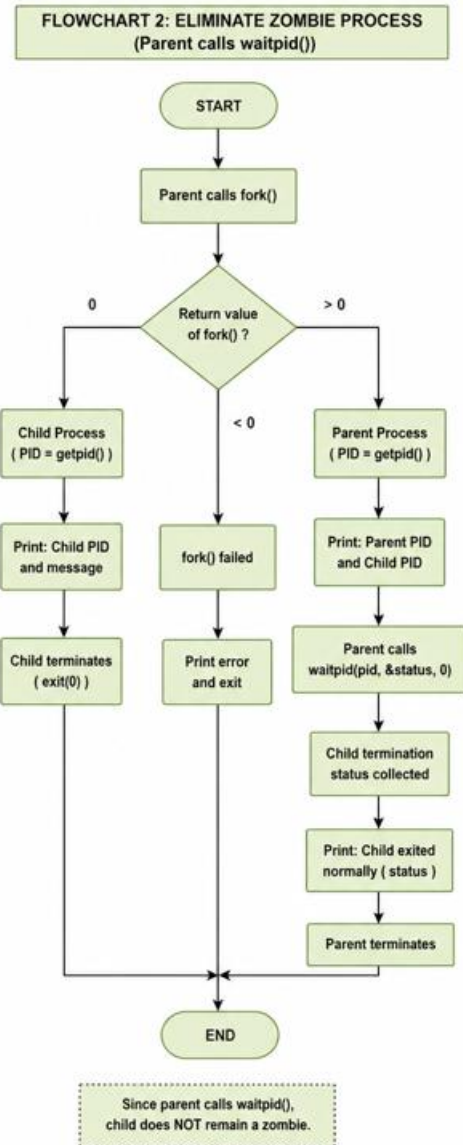
    return 0;
}

```

```

varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ nano zombie.c
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ gcc zombie.c -o zombie
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ ./zombie
Parent Process
Parent PID = 2178
Child PID = 2179
Parent waiting for child...
Child Process
Child PID = 2179
Child is terminating...
Child collected successfully.
No zombie process remains.
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$ ps -o pid,ppid,state,stat,cmd | grep zombie
 2181    1916 S S+  grep --color=auto zombie
varshini@DESKTOP-BLT5L3R:~$

```



### Final Observation

The child process initially became a zombie because the parent did not collect its exit status. After adding wait(), the parent waits for the child and collects its termination status, thereby eliminating the zombie process.